

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Shame Work

*A Journal for Putting Down What Was Never
Yours*



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · honest work

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Shame is the voice that says you ARE the mistake —
not that you made one. It grows in silence and secrecy,
and it shrinks the moment it's written down and looked at.

That's what this journal is for.

These pages will ask you to be honest about things
you've maybe never said anywhere. Go at your own pace.

Nobody sees this but you.

And a caring note: if shame is tangled up with trauma,
this work pairs powerfully with a therapist. You don't
have to untangle the heaviest knots alone.

STARTING POINT

The Weight Check



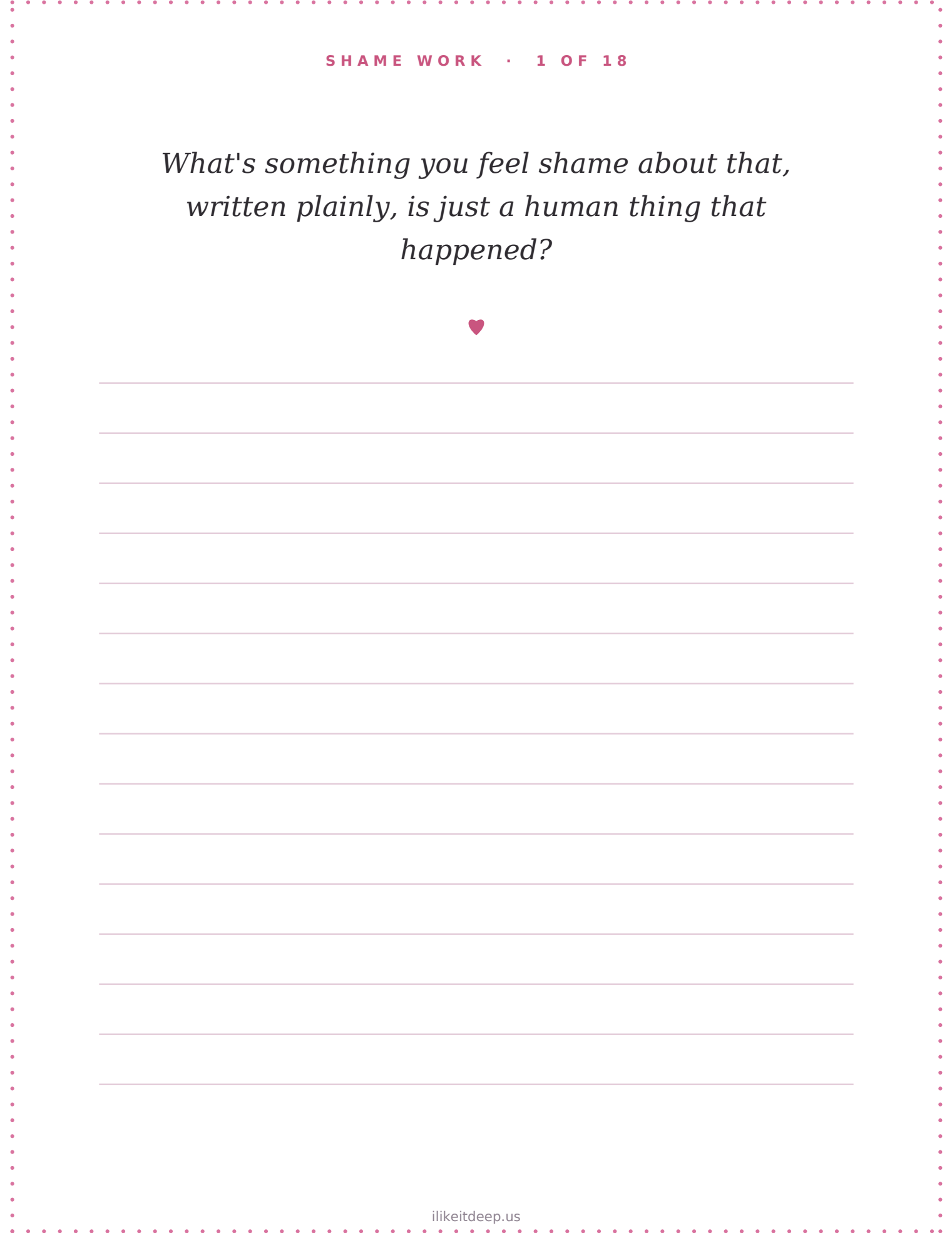
Without judging it, write down what shame feels like in your body — where it sits, when it shows up, what it makes you want to do.

PART ONE

Naming It



*Shame loses power the moment it has to
introduce itself.*

[illegible][illegible]

[illegible][illegible]

*What does your shame say to you, word for word?
Write the actual sentences.*

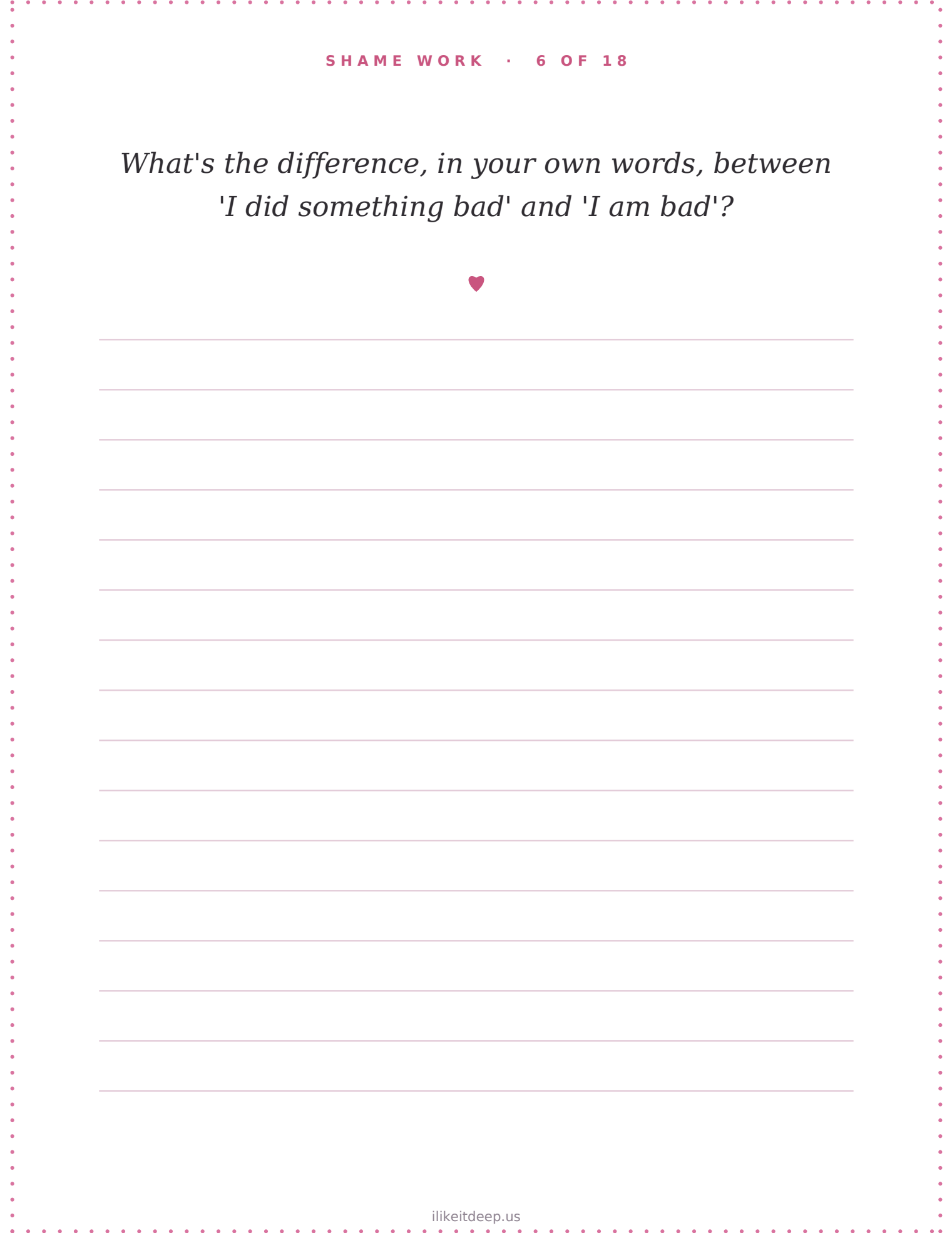


Whose voice is that, really? Because it wasn't originally yours.



What parts of yourself do you hide from people you love — and what are you afraid would happen if they saw?



[illegible][illegible]

PART TWO

Sorting It



*Some of what you carry was handed to you.
Time to check the labels.*

What shame are you carrying that actually belongs to someone else — something done TO you, not BY you?



[illegible][illegible]

What would you say to a friend who confessed the exact thing you're most ashamed of?



*Where did you learn what a 'good' woman, partner,
or person is — and who profits from you never
feeling like enough?*



What mistake have you punished yourself for longer than any judge would have?



*If shame is a debt, haven't you paid it? What would
'paid in full' look like?*



PART THREE

Putting It Down



You don't outrun shame. You out-love it.

What's one shame you're ready to say out loud to one safe person? Who might that person be?



What would you do this year if shame wasn't allowed to vote?



*Write the apology you've been waiting to receive.
Then read it to yourself slowly.*



What are you actually proud of that shame never lets you say? Say it here, in full sentences.



What boundary would you set if you believed you deserved to take up space?



*Write a few sentences of forgiveness to yourself.
Not because it didn't matter — because you matter
more.*



When the Shame Wave Hits



Shame spikes fast. These are small circuit-breakers — check the ones you'll try.

- ☐ Name it quietly: 'this is shame talking'
- ☐ Put a hand on your chest and slow your breath
- ☐ Text one safe person — even just 'rough moment'
- ☐ Say the fact out loud without the story attached
- ☐ Ask: would I say this sentence to someone I love?
- ☐ Move your body for two minutes — walk, stretch, shake it out
- ☐ Write the shame thought down, then write the kinder truth under it
- ☐ Delay the spiral: 'I'll think about this in one hour'
- ☐ Drink water, unclench your jaw, drop your shoulders
- ☐ Come back to this journal and read your own words

Evidence Against the Shame



Every kindness you've done, every hard thing you've survived, every person who chose you — log the proof here. Shame hates receipts.

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BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



You wrote down the things shame told you to keep secret.

That is exactly how it dies — slowly, in the light.

Some of what you carried was never yours. You're allowed
to set it down and walk lighter. Not perfect. Lighter.

If the roots here run into trauma, please consider doing
this work alongside a therapist. Shame heals fastest
in the presence of someone safe who doesn't look away.



*You were never the mistake. Put it
down now.*



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